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Education

University of Michigan — Ann Arbor, USA
Ph.D. in Economics — 2017 –2024
M.A. in Economics — 2017 –2019

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Mexico City, MEX
M.A. in Economic Theory — 2014 –2017
B.A. in Economics — 2008 –2013

Professional Experience

Banco de México — Mexico City, MEX
Research Economist at the Research Department — 2024 –Current
Junior Economist at the Research Department — 2013 –2017

International Monetary Fund — Washington DC, USA
Summer Intern at the Western Hemisphere Department — Summer 2021

Working Papers

- **"Rules of Origin and the Use of NAFTA"** joint with Alfonso Cebreros
  Resubmitted to the *Journal of International Economics*

  We study how RoO affect the use of NAFTA. To qualify for preferential tariffs, exporters using NAFTA must comply with RoO. We document: (i) the smallest and largest firms use NAFTA less intensively than medium-sized firms, and (ii) the reduction in sourcing from non-NAFTA countries when using NAFTA increases with firm size. We rationalize these findings in a partial equilibrium model of input sourcing with fixed costs of using NAFTA and of sourcing from foreign suppliers, where the opportunity cost of complying with RoO rises with firm size. Using data on Mexican exporters, we quantify the model and conduct counterfactuals. A 20 p.p. increase in RoO strictness lowers U.S. intermediate exports to Mexico by 3.89%, while a 20 p.p. tariff increase raises them by 3.18%. Additional exercises highlight the importance of accounting for adjustment costs, and that although stricter RoO can increase regional content, they reduce the scale of trade.

- **"Natural Disasters, and Scarring Effects"** joint with Weicheng Lian and Raadhika Vishvesh
  IMF Working Paper No. 2022/253, December 2022

  Medium-term scarring of natural disasters can emerge if the immediate damage caused by an extremely large shock results in persistent disruption to production capacity. This paper uses a novel empirical approach, following the literature on hysteresis, to explore this issue for countries vulnerable to natural disasters. By quantifying the dynamic effects of natural disasters on real GDP per capita for a large number of episodes using a synthetic control approach (SCA) and focusing on severe shocks, we demonstrate that a persistently large deviation of real GDP per capita from the counterfactual trend exists five years after a severe shock in many countries. The findings highlight the importance and urgency of building ex-ante resilience to avoid scarring effects for countries prone to natural disasters, such as those in the Caribbean region.

Work in Progress

- **"Information Spillovers in Export Destinations"**

  We study how information spillovers —learning about new destinations through export activity —shape firms' entry and exit decisions in foreign markets. Using Mexican customs data, we document the existence of these spillovers and show that firms leverage their export experience to refine subsequent market choices. To rationalize these patterns, we develop a dynamic model of export supply with learning, where firms select destinations based on beliefs about profitability. We quantify the model by estimating fixed costs and foreign markets' export profitability, and use counterfactual simulations to assess the role of spillovers in shaping destination diversification. The results indicate that, absent spillovers, the share of Mexican firms exporting beyond the USA would fall by 21.6%. Moreover, reducing fixed costs in a given country not only raises entry into that market but also stimulates exporting to other destinations.

- **"Global Supply Chains and Regional Shocks"** joint with Nadim Elayan

  We explore how regional shocks affect the formation of global supply chains, recognizing the trade-off firms face when choosing the sourcing location of their inputs. On the one hand, sourcing from similar countries entails a lower risk of being exposed to regional shocks but on the other, it implies firms are less able to take advantage of the pattern of comparative advantage across the World. Using customs data on Mexican firms we document how firms weigh this trade-off, whether there is sectoral heterogeneity in this behavior, and study whether this heterogeneity is the result of sector-specific input complementarity. We build a model of global sourcing that accounts for comparative advantage being driven by geographical location and exposure to regional shocks. With our model, we explore the effects that an episode of increased regional risk, namely the COVID-19 global pandemic, had on firms' global supply chain formation.

- **"Labor Rights Enforcement and Trade Flows: Evidence from the USMCA Rapid Response Mechanism"** joint with Harriet Brookes Gray & Stephen Nyarko

  The Rapid Response Labor Mechanism (RRM) introduced under the USMCA agreement in 2020 is a government-to-firm mechanism that allows the US government to delay customs processing of imports from specific manufacturing plants in Mexico if there is evidence that the manufacturing plant is violating Mexican labor law. This paper explores three main questions: (i) How do trade links and volumes change for Mexican establishments directly targetted by the RRM, both to the US and worldwide? (ii) How do establishments susceptible to the RRM change their trading behavior due to the more strict regulatory environment? And (iii) How do US firms adjust their supply networks in response to increased chances of disruption from Mexican suppliers?

- **"Trade Rerouting: Theory and Evidence"** joint with Carlos Goes

  This paper develops a simple model of trade rerouting, in which exporters choose whether to ship goods directly to a destination market or divert them through a third-country intermediary. Rerouting introduces double marginalization, as both producers and intermediaries apply markups, leading to welfare-reducing inefficiencies. The model delivers clear predictions: when direct trade costs increase, more goods are rerouted, shifting the composition of trade flows and affecting prices and welfare. We derive closed-form expressions for the welfare effects of such changes. To test these predictions, we use Mexican customs data and exploit the sharp increase in U.S. tariffs on Chinese imports, documenting how firms adjusted their routing strategies in response. The results offer new insight into how tariff shocks reshape global trade patterns through indirect channels.

- **"The Migration Effects of Trade Wars"** joint with Lorenzo Aldeco and Andrea Miranda

  This paper examines the effects of trade policy shocks on migration flows, focusing on how the 2018 US–China trade war reshaped production and labor dynamics in Mexico. Following the imposition of higher tariffs and import restrictions on Chinese goods, some Chinese manufacturing firms might have relocated production abroad to circumvent trade barriers. Mexico represents a particularly attractive destination for such relocation due to its geographic proximity to the United States and its extensive network of free trade agreements, including USMCA. We hypothesize that this shift in production patterns led to an increase in migration flows —both managerial and labor-related— from China to Mexico. To test this hypothesis, we combine detailed Mexican customs data with official migration flow statistics to identify the extent and timing of production relocation and associated migration responses. By linking firm-level trade data to bilateral migration movements, we provide empirical evidence on how international trade conflicts can indirectly influence migration patterns through global value chain reconfiguration. Our results contribute to the growing literature on the interaction between trade shocks, production networks, and international mobility, highlighting the broader demographic and economic spillovers of trade wars.

- **"Firm Markups and Value-Added Rules"** joint with Emilio Colombi & Leticia Juarez

  We study whether value-added rules induce exporting firms to charge higher markups. A significant fraction of Rules of Origin in Free Trade Agreements establish that for a firm to be able to export its products at a preferential rate, it must comply with having at least some share of value-added being generated at FTA member countries. In an environment in which markups are endogenous, firms could choose to increase their markups in order to comply with these regulations. This paper presents a tractable model of export supply, in which a firm's optimal pricing strategy is distorted by the presence of Value-Added Rules as the FTA introduces a discontinuity in firms' profits. We derive theoretical predictions for a firm's optimal price in an export market, as a function of these rules, and empirically estimate this relationship using plant-level and Rules of Origin data.

- **"Is A Trade War Also A Gender War? Gender-specific Income Shocks and the Dynamics of Violence Against Women"** joint with Qinyou Hu, Xiongfei Li, and Diego Ascarza-Mendoza

  This paper studies whether international trade conflicts generate gender-specific income and employment shocks that affect violence against women. We exploit spillovers from the U.S.–China trade war to Mexico, a major nearshoring destination during the conflict, to examine how trade-induced shocks to male and female labor markets shape the dynamics of violence against women. Using rich microdata from Mexico's National Survey on the Dynamics of Household Relationships (ENDIREH), which provides detailed measures of physical, emotional, psychological, and economic violence across multiple contexts, we combine individual-level violence outcomes with municipality-level exposure to tariff changes. Our identification strategy relies on a shift-share design that leverages pre-trade-war gender-specific employment structures and sectoral tariff shocks arising from U.S.–China and U.S.–Mexico trade conflicts. We document that trade-induced income and employment shocks have asymmetric effects by gender and context, with adverse labor market shocks concentrated among men leading to significant increases in intimate partner violence, while positive shocks to female employment mitigate certain forms of violence. We further explore mechanisms related to employment reallocation, income changes, and household bargaining power, and assess robustness to migration, remittances, and local economic conditions. Our findings highlight an important and previously understudied social spillover of trade policy, showing that international trade conflicts can exacerbate gender-based violence through local labor market disruptions.

Presentations

- **2026:**
  Midwest International Trade & Theory Spring Conference, 2026 ITAM Alumni Conference, Southern Economic Association Meetings (scheduled)
- **2025:**
  Midwest International Trade & Theory Spring Conference, Inaugural International Seminar on Trade Conference, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, LACEA-LAMES 2025, Trade Value Chains and Financial Linkages in the Global Economy Conference.
- **2024:**
  Banco de México, ITAM, National Taiwan University, Universidad del Pacífico, Universidad Diego Portales, University of Nottingham, University of Tokyo, USMCA Central Banks Meeting
- **2019-2023:**
  International/Macro Workshop, International Economics and Summer seminars at the University of Michigan, Western Hemisphere Department and CARTAC seminars at the International Monetary Fund

Referee Service

IMF Economic Review, *Latin American Economic Review*, *Banco de México Working Papers Series*

Teaching Experience

- **Instructor** at Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Winter 2026
  Industrial Organization (ECO-14301)
- **Head Teaching Assistant** at University of Michigan — Winter 2024
  Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 102), Professor Oleg Zamulin
- **Head Teaching Assistant** at University of Michigan — Fall 2021 and 2022, Summer 2022
  Intermediate Macroeconomics (ECON 402), Professor Edward Cho
- **Head Teaching Assistant** at University of Michigan — Fall 2020, Winter 2021, 2022 and 2023
  Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 102), Professor Edward Cho
- **Teaching Assistant** at University of Michigan — Fall 2023
  Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 101), Professor Jeffrey Ward
- **Teaching Assistant** at University of Michigan — Winter 2020
  Government Regulation of Industry (ECON 432), Professor Zach Brown
- **Teaching Assistant** at University of Michigan — Fall 2018 and 2019, Winter 2019
  Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 102), Professor Edward Cho
- **Teaching Assistant** at Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Fall 2016
  Applied Macroeconometrics (ECO-10517), Professor Ignacio Lobato
- **Teaching Assistant** at Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Winter 2016
  Advanced Microeconometrics (graduate) (ECO-20513), Professor Igor Kheifets
- **Teaching Assistant** at Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Winter 2016
  Applied Microeconometrics (ECO-10516), Professor Igor Kheifets

Research Assistant Experience

University of Michigan — Ann Arbor, USA
Research Assistant for Professor Kyle Handley — Summer 2020
Research Assistant for Professor Andrei Levchenko — Summer 2018 and 2019

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Mexico City, MEX
Research Assistant for Professor Kensuke Teshima and Professor Rahul Giri — 2012 –2013

Fellowships and Awards

- **Summer Research Fellowship** at University of Michigan — Summer 2018 and 2019
- **Graduate Studies Fellowship** at University of Michigan — 2017–2018
- **Graduate Studies Scholarship** at Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — 2014–2017

Skills

- **Statistical Computing:** Stata, R, EViews
- **Numerical Computing:** MATLAB
- **Geographic Information:** ArcGIS
- **Document Editor:** LaTex, Office

Languages

- **Spanish:** Native
- **English:** Fluent
- **German:** Basic

Professional Service

- Admissions Committee at University of Michigan 2019, 2020
  Member of the Ph.D. Admissions Committee for the Economics Department at the University of Michigan
- Gaceta de Economía at Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México 2014–2016
  Member of the Editorial Committee and later Co-Director of ITAM's student-led economics journal

Citizenship

Mexico and Germany

References

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